



Providing Virtual Care for Anxiety

Clinical Case Quiz

Treating an Anxious Patient

A 25-year-old female calls Gcn because she is experiencing frequent panic attacks. She was previously on Xanax 0.5mg as needed but ran out. She last took Xanax a month ago. She'd like a refill and told you she is currently on no other prescription medication. She does not appear to sound like she is in acute distress. All the following are appropriate over a virtual encounter EXCEPT:

- a. Consider initiation of an SSRI
- b. Refill Xanax 0.5 mg
- c. Consider follow up with behavioral health
- d. Suggest follow up with PCP if symptoms persist

The answer is all except b.



Choosing a Treatment Option

Selecting an Appropriate Medication

Fluoxetine, sertraline, citalopram, and escitalopram are some SSRI agents that can be initiated virtually for uncontrolled anxiety. Initiate a low dose and advise a follow-up with their PCP in the next 2 to 4 weeks. See the Knowledge Center's "[Depression and Anxiety Med Sheet](#)" for more information.

We can also provide the member the following centralized behavioral health phone number to assist in the follow-up with behavioral health services: 833-KP-WITH-U.

It is not recommended to provide benzodiazepines over virtual encounters.